

# Shramay Palta

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## Research Interests

Natural Language Processing, Natural Language Reasoning and Inference, Commonsense Reasoning, Human-AI Alignment, Reasoning under Uncertainty, Explainability and Interpretability

## Education

- 2021–present **University of Maryland, College Park**, *Ph.D. in Computer Science*  
**Thesis:** Graded Judgments of Plausibility in Commonsense Reasoning  
**Advisor:** Professor Rachel Rudinger
- 2021–2023 **University of Maryland, College Park**, *M.S. in Computer Science*  
**Advisor:** Professor Rachel Rudinger
- 2017–2021 **BITS Pilani (Pilani Campus)**, *B.E. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering*  
**Advisors:** Professor Ashok Agrawala (UMD) and Professor Navneet Goyal (BITS)

## Professional Experience

- 2025 **Research Intern, Microsoft**  
Hosted by Dr. Mengting Wan (Office of Applied Research) and Michael Bentley (Office AI Science). Developed a model router for enterprise user queries, engineering a solution that strictly optimized for accuracy, operational cost, and system latency.
- 2024 **Research Intern, Microsoft Research**  
Hosted by Dr. Scott Counts. Built and evaluated a classifier for user and agent expertise in AI chat interactions, which led to a research paper on the implications of User-AI expertise alignment. The classifier is scheduled for adoption by IDEAS in E+D.
- 2019 **Data Science Intern, TurnoutNow**  
Used real-time location data from IoT BLE Beacons and natural language generation tools with live data connections to generate narratives for end users.

## Publications

Preprints, Under Review and Works in Progress.

- Work in Progress **Shramay Palta**, Rachel Rudinger. *The Ghost in the Discourse: Tracing Semantic Leakage to Implicit Discourse Connectives*.
- Preprint, Under Review **Shramay Palta**, Peter Rankel, Sarah Wiegrefe, Rachel Rudinger. *Everything is Plausible: Investigating the Impact of LLM Rationales on Human Notions of Plausibility*.

## Conference Papers

- IJCNLP-  
AACL 2025 **Shramay Palta**, Nirupama Chandrasekaran, Rachel Rudinger, Scott Counts. *Speaking the Right Language: The Impact of Expertise (Mis)Alignment in User-AI Interactions*. International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing & Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics.

- EMNLP 2024 **Shramay Palta**, Nishant Balepur, Peter Rankel, Sarah Wiegrefe, Marine Carpuat, Rachel Rudinger. *Plausibly Problematic Questions in Multiple-Choice Benchmarks for Commonsense Reasoning*. Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing.
- ECCV 2024 Gowthami Somepalli, Anubhav Gupta, Kamal Gupta, **Shramay Palta**, Micah Goldblum, Jonas Geiping, Abhinav Shrivastava, Tom Goldstein. *Investigating Style Similarity in Diffusion Models*. European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV).
- ACL 2024 Nishant Balepur, **Shramay Palta**, Rachel Rudinger. *It's Not Easy Being Wrong: Large Language Models Struggle with Process of Elimination Reasoning*. Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics.
- ACL 2023 **Shramay Palta**, Rachel Rudinger. *FORK: A Bite-Sized Test Set for Probing Culinary Cultural Biases in Commonsense Reasoning Models*. Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics.

## Selected Invited Talks

- 2025 **Graded Judgments of Plausibility in Commonsense Reasoning**, *Invited Guest Lecture*, Rutgers University Graduate NLP Class.
- 2024 **Uncertainty and its Impact on Commonsense Reasoning**, *Guest Lecture*, UMD Graduate NLP Seminar.
- 2023 **Prompting, In-context Learning, and Instruct Tuning**, *Guest Lecture*, UMD Undergraduate Natural Language Processing course.

## Skills

- Languages: Python, R
- Frameworks and Libraries: PyTorch, HuggingFace, pandas, numpy, sklearn
- Tools: Git, LaTeX

## Selected Honor and Awards

- 2026 **Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant and CS Travel Grant**, *UMD*  
Awarded the Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant and CS Travel Grant (worth \$1,400) for presenting my research at ACL 2026.
- 2021–2023 **Dean's Fellowship and Chair's Fellowship**, *UMD*  
Awarded the Graduate School Dean's Fellowship and the Chair's Fellowship Award for outstanding academic achievement.

## Voluntary Service

### Reviewing

- ACL Rolling Review (ARR): 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

### Other

- Reviewer: UMD CS Graduate Admissions Committee
- President: CS GradCo: an organization aimed to improve the experiences of all CS graduate students as they progress through their program.